· STRATEGIC WORK SAMPLE

Building Customer Lifetime Value Through Integrated User Engagement

A First Principles Approach

USER LIFECYCLE · SEGMENTATION · JOURNEY ARCHITECTURE · CLV · CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

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THE STRUCTURAL PROBLEM

Journey fragmentation is an organisational problem, not a CRM problem

Marketing

Optimises campaign metrics — open rates, CTR, send volume. Defines success by departmental KPIs.

Product & Tech

Optimises feature adoption and technical delivery. Defines success by product engagement metrics.

Business Units

Each vertical optimises its own conversion and revenue. Mobility ≠ Real Estate ≠ Jobs lifecycle.

The user

Experiences the gaps between them. Receives inconsistent messaging, broken journeys, and repeated onboarding.

The user experiences the gaps — not the departmental boundaries

THE THESIS

The answer is not better campaigns. It is a different operating model.

CURRENT STATE

Fragmented by function

- Each function owns its slice of the journey
- Lifecycle strategy split across Marketing, Product and BUs
- User database managed as a tool, not a strategic asset
- Onboarding, engagement and retention treated as separate programmes
- CLV unmeasured — acquisition bias dominates resource allocation

TARGET STATE

Integrated lifecycle architecture

- Central lifecycle function owns end-to-end user journey
- Shared KPI hierarchy: CLV as the primary steering metric
- Centralised CRM serves vertical-specific needs without fragmenting UX
- Onboarding → engagement → retention → win-back as one connected flow
- Database health managed proactively as a commercial asset

Sustainable commercial growth comes from shared ownership of the user — not isolated departmental success

USER SEGMENTATION

The same platform — very different user journeys

Lifecycle architecture must serve both profiles without creating separate fragmented experiences

SEGMENT A · ENTRY & ACTIVATION

The new or occasional user

Who	Mobile-first, discovery-led. Finds platform via referral, social or search. Low trust, high sensitivity to friction.
Wants	Fast onboarding, immediate value signal, no repeated data requests. Wants to see the platform deliver before committing.
Risk	Abandons at first friction point. Onboarding quality determines whether they ever activate in a second vertical.
Lifecycle lever	Onboarding sequence quality + cross-vertical activation within 30 days.

SEGMENT B · RETENTION & GROWTH

The established multi-vertical user

Who	Experienced user active in 2+ verticals. Higher trust, higher CLV. Motivated by convenience and relevance.
Wants	Personalised lifecycle communication, seamless cross-vertical experience, recognition of history and behaviour.
Risk	Churns silently when communication becomes irrelevant or repetitive. Hard to win back at comparable CAC.
Lifecycle lever	CLV-based segmentation + trigger-based retention + win-back architecture.

Key insight: the young user is won or lost at onboarding — the established user is won or lost at relevance.

JOURNEY ARCHITECTURE

Two users — four stages — critical divergence points

DISCOVERY	ONBOARDING	ENGAGEMENT	RETENTION & GROWTH
Social feed, referral link, organic search. Phone-first. No brand loyalty yet.	Friction = exit. Wants value in <2 min. Data requests must feel worth it.	Re-engages if first cross-vertical suggestion is relevant and timely.	Won by personalisation. Lost by irrelevant batch campaigns.
Intent-driven. Arrives knowing the platform. Discovery phase is fast.	Wants recognised, not re-onboarded. History should be visible.	Deep engagement across multiple verticals. Trigger-based communication lands.	CLV compounds if milestones are recognised. Churns silently when ignored.

The decisive insight: Segment A is won at onboarding. Segment B is retained through relevance. The same lifecycle strategy fails both.

COMMERCIAL ARCHITECTURE

CLV is economics, not a CRM metric

Desirability and retention move the entire unit economics — this is why the lifecycle function is a growth lever, not a cost centre.

CLV = Acquisition value × Repeat frequency × Relationship duration × Margin × Referral multiplier

Lower CAC

Users acquired through referral and organic engagement cost 20–35% less than paid acquisition. Retention compounds this over time.

KPI: CAC index

Higher conversion

A user who already trusts the platform converts in new verticals at 2–3× the rate of a new user. Onboarding quality is the lever.

KPI: Cross-vertical activation rate

Frequency & basket

Relevant, trigger-based lifecycle communication drives repeat engagement without incremental acquisition spend.

KPI: Repeat rate & AOV

Organic referral

Satisfied users with high CLV generate the highest-quality new user referrals. Retention investment compounds into acquisition.

KPI: Referral-driven new users

The lifecycle function that manages CLV as its primary metric will out-perform the one that manages campaign open rates.

OPERATING MODEL

The governance model that resolves fragmentation

Based on Lead Forum — a structure built and validated at Topdanmark/If across competing business units

01

Monthly lifecycle governance cadence

Eliminates the gap between BU priorities and central lifecycle strategy

All BU heads and Marketing/Product meet on standardised lifecycle KPI dashboard — shared view of user behaviour, NPS drivers and campaign performance. Forces alignment before execution, not after.

02

CLV-based segmentation as shared resource

Same user, same logic — regardless of which BU they last touched

Central segmentation model replaces vertical-specific lists. User value determines communication priority, discount access and win-back eligibility — consistently across all verticals.

03

Centralised CRM serving vertical-specific needs

Scale without fragmentation — the core architectural challenge

One CRM operating model with vertical-configurable templates and trigger logic. Enables Mobility to send different content than Real Estate while preserving consistent user experience and data integrity.

Validated result: 5–8 million euros incremental commercial impact (2024–25). Private sales at all-time high.

INITIATIVE PRIORITIZATION

Where to build first — ranked by CLV impact

Not all lifecycle initiatives are equal — this is the sequencing logic

RANK	INITIATIVE	EFFORT	CLV IMPACT	TIME TO IMPACT	RATIONALE
01	**Onboarding quality redesign**	Low	High	0–30 days	First-friction fix. Highest impact per user acquired. Lifts cross-vertical activation immediately.
02	**CLV-based user segmentation**	Low	High	0–60 days	Replaces volume logic with value logic. Changes what the whole lifecycle function optimises for.
03	**Cross-vertical lifecycle triggers**	Medium	High	30–90 days	Revenue on existing users at near-zero acquisition cost. Compounds CLV without new spend.
04	**Win-back programme architecture**	Medium	High	30–90 days	Recovers users on already-paid CAC. Documented 20–35% win-back rate achievable.
05	**Referral programme redesign**	Medium	High	90–180 days	Best users generate best leads. CAC falls structurally as programme scales.
06	**Database health & compliance**	High	Medium	60–180 days	Protects deliverability, consent integrity and long-term CRM asset quality.

EXECUTION & GOVERNANCE

Phased roadmap — prove, then scale

The goal is not to transform everything at once — it is to generate evidence and build momentum

Phase 1 · 0–60 days

Diagnose & Align

- Map current user journey fragmentation across all five verticals
- Audit CRM database health and segmentation logic
- Establish lifecycle governance cadence with all BU heads
- Define CLV as the primary shared metric — with stakeholder buy-in

Risk: internal resistance to shared KPI ownership

Phase 2 · 60–180 days

Build & Activate

- Redesign onboarding sequences by user segment
- Deploy CLV-based segmentation replacing volume logic
- Launch cross-vertical lifecycle triggers with control groups
- Activate win-back programme with documented eligibility criteria

Risk: technical debt in CRM infrastructure

Phase 3 · 180–365 days

Scale & Optimise

- Referral programme redesign — three-tier with automated consent flow
- Community and loyalty layer for high-CLV segment
- CAC index target: move from baseline toward -25% over 12 months
- Quarterly lifecycle board review with evidence-led adjustment

Risk: attribution complexity across verticals

Principle: pilot with one vertical, measure with control groups, scale with evidence.

»Sustainable engagement comes from shared ownership
of the user — not from isolated departmental success.«

The problem	Journey fragmentation is organisational, not technical
The architecture	CLV-based lifecycle with centralised CRM serving vertical-specific needs
The governance	Shared KPI cadence forcing alignment across Marketing, Product & BUs
The proof	5–8M euros incremental at Topdanmark/If — same structural challenge, same solution

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